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ARCHITECTURE

Desi Deco

There's a growing interest in India's* Art Deco *architecture, buoyed by social media

Windows with arched eyebrows. Glorious sunbursts on the floor. Intricate geometric patterns. Towering ziggurats. Swastika patterns curving across a rounded balcony. These aren't just glimpses of an artist's fantastic reverie, but actual architectural features on certain buildings. Just keep your eyes open in your own city. Chances are, there is at least a neighbourhood or a building that has been built in the characteristic Art Deco style that was born in France and became popular globally in the 1920s, but caught the

INSTA DEKKO

Instagram handles ***devoted to*** *Indian Art Deco architecture*

@decoindelhi
@calcuttahouses
@artdecomumbai
@artdecomadras
@artdecokerala
@artdecopune
@beyond_heritage

A wander through the National Gallery of Modern Art's (NGMA) latest exhibition—*Geoffrey Bawa: It is Essential To be There*—is a rewarding experience. Over his life, the celebrated Sri Lankan architect, who passed away in 2003, was involved in a prolific series of projects, from hotels, houses, schools and universities to offices, factories and public buildings, going on to the new Sri Lankan Parliament building.

The exhibition showcases a rich vein of work, from architectural sketches and drawings to photographs and models of his buildings. It's immediately obvious why Bawa was so feted—his work is, in a word, beautiful, exuding a sense of wholeness as though the buildings are somehow natural parts of the landscapes they sit within. There's also a skill to the sketches on display that makes them much more than technical drawings—many could well be called works of art.

Visiting the exhibition is a largely short and sweet affair—some 20 minutes of perusing from end to end, perhaps 45 if you're dedicated—but what can be occasionally annoying is the curation, which leans more towards style than substance.

ART

THE IMPORTANCE OF BEING PRESENT



An exhibition at NGMA, Delhi, celebrates Sri Lankan architect **Geoffrey Bawa's** enduring legacy

